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Adaptive illuminator sequencing

Abstract

An eyewear device is disclosed including an illumination device including illumination sources, each illumination source including a first illuminator, a second illuminator, and a third illuminator, and a spatial light modulator coupled to the illumination device to control when each of the first, second, and third illuminators are on during an illumination frame. The spatial light modulator is adapted to turn on the first illuminator while the second and third illuminators are off, turn on the second illuminator while the first and third illuminators are off, turn on the third illuminator while the first and second illuminators are off during a third time period of the illumination frame, and turn on the first, second and third illuminators during a fourth time period. An illumination method is also disclosed.

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Background/Summary

CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATIONS (1) This application is a Continuation of U.S. application Ser. No. 17/542,711 filed on Dec. 6, 2021, which is a Continuation of U.S. application Ser. No. 16/710,996 filed on Dec. 11, 2019, now U.S. Pat. 11,196,970, and claims priority to U.S. Provisional Application Ser. No. 62/783,328 filed on Dec. 21, 2018, the contents of all of which are incorporated fully herein by reference.

FIELD OF THE INVENTION

(1) The present invention relates to light projectors and, more particularly, to projectors with adaptive illuminators.

BACKGROUND OF THE INVENTION

(2) Consumer electronics devices utilize projectors to display images to their users. The projectors include illuminators such as LEDs to create light for displaying the images. In environments where the ambient level of light is high, the projectors may increase the current to the illuminators to boost brightness in order to improve visibility. Increasing the current to the illuminators, however, causes the illuminators to generate heat, which limits the usefulness of such an approach.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

- (1) The invention is best understood from the following detailed description when read in connection with the accompanying drawings, with like elements having the same reference numerals. When a plurality of similar elements is present, a single reference numeral may be assigned to the plurality of similar elements with a small letter designation referring to specific elements. When referring to the elements collectively or to a non-specific one or more of the elements, the small letter designation may be dropped. This emphasizes that according to common practice, the various features of the drawings are not drawn to scale unless otherwise indicated. On the contrary, the dimensions of the various features may be expanded or reduced for clarity. Included in the drawings are the following figures:
- (2) FIG. 1 is a perspective view of an eyewear device;
 - (3) FIG. 2 is a top partial view of the eyewear device of FIG. 1;
 - (4) FIG. 3 is a block diagram of hardware components of the eyewear device of FIG. 1;
 - (5) FIG. 4A is a timing diagram for implementation of a four color scheme in the eyewear device of FIG. 1;
 - (6) FIG. 4B is a timing diagram for implementation of a seven color scheme in the eyewear device of FIG. 1;
 - (7) FIG. 5 is an equation for determining current and timing requirements to produce the color white;
 - (8) FIG. 6 is a flow chart of steps to project an image with the eyewear device of FIG. 1.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION OF THE INVENTION

(9) In the following detailed description, numerous specific details are set forth by way of examples in order to provide a thorough understanding of the relevant teachings. However, it should be apparent to those skilled in the art that the present teachings may be practiced without such details. In other instances, description of well-known methods, procedures, components, and circuitry are set forth at a relatively high-level, without detail, in order to avoid unnecessarily obscuring aspects of the present teachings.

(10) The term “coupled” or “connected” as used herein refers to any logical, optical, physical or electrical connection, link or the like by which electrical or magnetic signals produced or supplied by one system element are imparted to another coupled or connected element. Unless described otherwise, coupled or connected elements or devices are not necessarily directly connected to one

another and may be separated by intermediate components, elements or communication media that may modify, manipulate or carry the electrical signals. As used herein, the term lens covers transparent or translucent pieces of glass or plastic having curved and/or flat surfaces that cause light to converge/diverge or that cause little or no convergence/divergence. The term “about” as used herein refers to a range of values surrounding an actual value, i.e., $\pm 10\%$.

(11) The orientations of an eyewear device, associated components and any complete devices as shown in any of the drawings, are given by way of example only, for illustration and discussion purposes. In operation, the eyewear device may be oriented in any other direction suitable to the particular application of the eyewear device, for example up, down, sideways, or any other orientation. Also, to the extent used herein, any directional term, such as front, rear, inwards, outwards, towards, left, right, lateral, longitudinal, up, down, upper, lower, top, bottom, side, horizontal, vertical, and diagonal are used by way of example only, and are not limiting as to direction or orientation of any depth-capturing camera or component of the depth-capturing camera constructed as otherwise described herein.

(12) Additional objects, advantages and novel features of the examples will be set forth in part in the following description, and in part will become apparent to those skilled in the art upon examination of the following and the accompanying drawings or may be learned by production or operation of the examples. The objects and advantages of the present subject matter may be realized and attained by means of the methodologies, instrumentalities and combinations particularly pointed out in the appended claims.

(13) FIG. 1 depicts an eyewear device **100**. Eyewear device **100** includes a support structure that has a frame **102**, a right temple **104a**, and a left temple **104b**. Frame **102** includes a right rim **106a** that supports a right lens **108a** and left rim **106b** that supports a left lens **108b**. A bridge **107** connects the left and right rims **106a** and **106b** and is adapted to receive a nose of the wearer. Eyewear device **100** additionally includes a spatial light modulator (SLM) **110**, an ambient light sensor (ALS) **112**, and a temperature sensor **114**, which will be described in further detail below.

(14) Eyewear device **100** additionally includes an optional chunk **116** between frame **102** and temple **104a** to house electronic components. Chunk **116** may be attached to frame **102** or integrated into frame **102**. A hinge **117** may connect temple **104a** to chunk **116** to enable folding of temple **104a** toward frame **102** in a conventional manner. Although an eyewear device example is provided, it is to be understood that the examples described herein may be applied to other electronic devices including color illuminator light sources.

(15) FIG. 2 conceptually depicts a portion of eyewear device **100** for use in describing optical characteristics. An illumination device **200** projects beams of light **202** under control of SLM **110** (FIG. 1). Projection optics **204** such as light guides and mirrors direct beams of light **202** into a waveguide **206**. In this example, lens **106a** defines the waveguide **206**. Beams of light **202** are internally reflected by waveguide **206** and exit waveguide **206** at an exit coupler such as a diffractive grating or coating for viewing in a view area by an eye **208** of a wearer of eyewear device **100**.

(16) FIG. 3 depicts hardware components **300** for use in eyewear device **100**. In addition to SLM **110**, ALS **112**, thermistor **114**, and illumination device **200** described above, hardware components **300** include a system controller **302**, a memory **304**, current controller **312**, and three illuminators. The three illuminators include a red illuminator **306** such as a red light emitting diode (LED) adapted to emit light at a first frequency associated with the color red, a green illuminator **308** such as a green LED adapted to emit light at a second frequency associated with the color green, and a blue illuminator **310** such as a blue LED adapted to emit light at a third frequency associated with the color blue. System controller **302** and current controller **312** may each be a microcontroller adapted to implement the functions described herein. Memory **304** may be non-volatile memory such as flash memory or erasable read only memory.

(17) System controller **302** receives temperature values from thermistor **114** and ambient light

levels from ALS **112** via transmission lines. System controller retrieves timing information for tuning on the illuminators from memory **304** based on the ambient light levels. System controller **302** also configures SLM **110** and current controller **312** based on ambient light levels and/or temperature to project light beams **202**. For example, system controller **302** may configure SLM **110** for high/low brightness in high/low ambient light conditions and may configure current controller **312** to reduce current (e.g., in accordance with current derating curves) if heat generation by the illuminators could damage the device.

(18) FIG. 4A depicts an example timing sequence for a four-color sequence (red, green, blue, white) to depict the color white. The timing sequence is over an illumination sequence of 16.67 ms (representing a 60 Hz frame of video). Because the sequence occurs with a short period of time from the human eye's perspective, the eye of a user interprets the combination of colors as occurring simultaneously rather than the colors individually. In the timing sequence of FIG. 4A, red illuminator (R) **306** is solely illuminated for a duration equal to $t_{\text{sub.1}} - t_{\text{sub.0}}$ (20%), green illuminator (G) **308** is solely illuminated for a duration equal to $t_{\text{sub.2}} - t_{\text{sub.1}}$ (40%), blue illuminator (B) **310** is solely illuminated for a duration equal to $t_{\text{sub.3}} - t_{\text{sub.2}}$ (10%), and all three illuminators (RGB; White; W) **306**, **308**, and **310** are illuminated for a duration equal to $t_{\text{sub.4}} - t_{\text{sub.3}}$ (30%). In a conventional system, the illuminators are not simultaneously lit. In order to increase brightness in such system, current to the illuminators are increased. Illuminating the illuminators simultaneously some of the time in accordance with the timing sequence in FIG. 4A enables more light to be delivered than in conventional system without increasing current. Additionally, the illuminators are still turned off periodically to allow for cooling.

(19) FIG. 4B depicts an example timing sequence for a seven-color sequence (red, green, blue, cyan, magenta, yellow, white) to depict the color white. The timing sequence is over an illumination sequence of 16.67 ms. In the timing sequence of FIG. 4B, red illuminator (R) **306** is solely illuminated for a duration equal to $t_{\text{sub.1}} - t_{\text{sub.0}}$ (20%), green illuminator (G) **308** is solely illuminated for a duration equal to $t_{\text{sub.2}} - t_{\text{sub.1}}$ (30%), blue illuminator (B) **310** is solely illuminated for a duration equal to $t_{\text{sub.3}} - t_{\text{sub.2}}$ (10%), the green illuminator **308** and blue illuminator **310** (GB; Cyan; C) are illuminated for a duration equal to $t_{\text{sub.4}} - t_{\text{sub.3}}$ (10%), the red illuminator **306** and blue illuminator **310** (RB; Magenta; M) are illuminated for a duration equal to $t_{\text{sub.5}} - t_{\text{sub.4}}$ (10%), the red illuminator **306** and green illuminator **308** (RG; Yellow; Y) are illuminated for a duration equal to $t_{\text{sub.6}} - t_{\text{sub.5}}$ (10%), and all three illuminators (RGB; White; W) **306**, **308**, and **310** are illuminated for a duration equal to $t_{\text{sub.7}} - t_{\text{sub.6}}$ (10%). Illuminating the illuminators simultaneously some of the time in accordance with the timing sequence in FIG. 4B enables more light to be delivered than in conventional system without increasing current. Additionally, the illuminators are still turned off periodically to allow for cooling.

(20) In an example, when displaying an overlapping color such as white, the red illuminator **306** is on during both $t_{\text{sub.R}}$ and $t_{\text{sub.W}}$, and off during $t_{\text{sub.G}}$ and $t_{\text{sub.B}}$, the green illuminator **308** is on during both $t_{\text{sub.G}}$ and $t_{\text{sub.W}}$ and off during $t_{\text{sub.R}}$ and $t_{\text{sub.B}}$, and the blue illuminator **310** is on during both $t_{\text{sub.B}}$ and $t_{\text{sub.W}}$, and off during $t_{\text{sub.R}}$ and $t_{\text{sub.G}}$.

(21) In an example, when displaying a non-overlapping color such as red, the red illuminator **306** is on during $t_{\text{sub.R}}$, but is off during $t_{\text{sub.W}}$. In another example, when displaying a non-overlapping color such as red, the red illuminator **306** is on during both $t_{\text{sub.R}}$ and $t_{\text{sub.W}}$ (with the green illuminator **308** and the blue illuminator **310** off during $t_{\text{sub.W}}$).

(22) FIG. 5 depicts an equation for use in determining characteristics such as current and timing values to configure the illuminators in order to produce a desired color white having particular intensity or brightness. Each illuminator has an International Commission on Illumination (CIE) tristimulus value (X, Y, Z), which is a three-dimensional value. An alternative representation of the tristimulus value is x, y, Y, where $x = X/(X+Y+Z)$, $y = Y/(X+Y+Z)$, and Y represents intensity or brightness. The "on" time for each illuminator is represented by "t" and is the duration when the illuminator is on, during which current "i" is supplied to the illuminator. When off, the illuminator

cools down thermally. To maintain color points (i.e., chromaticity values), the current (i) supply to each illuminator is set to a constant value. For example, the current value for the red illuminator **306** when showing red, magenta, yellow, and white is constant throughout the timing sequence. (23) In an example, the system adjusts brightness to address visibility based on ambient light conditions by adapting the duration when all illuminators are on (t.sub.W) for a four color system and (t.sub.W, t.sub.C, t.sub.M, and t.sub.Y) for a seven color system. There is a direct correlation between system brightness and time duration for overlapping illuminator colors t.sub.W (for a four color system) and t.sub.W, t.sub.C, t.sub.M, and t.sub.Y (for a seven color system). An optimal set of operational parameters (current and duration for each illuminator) are chosen for each system. For example, the eyewear **100** optimizes the SLM **110** to run at a brightness of Y.sub.0 for an ambient temperature of T.sub.0, a brightness of Y.sub.1 for an ambient temperature of T.sub.1, and a brightness of Y.sub.2 for an ambient temperature of T.sub.2. For higher ambient light levels, the duration of the overlapping color(s) is increased to improve visibility. Conversely, for lower ambient light levels, the duration of the overlapping color(s) is decreased to reduce power consumption. When the duration of the overlapping color(s) is high/low, the duration of the non-overlapping colors (t.sub.R, t.sub.G, and t.sub.B) are increased/reduced to compensate for the time in the illumination frame that the overlapping color(s) are not in use.

(24) Determination of the optimal operational parameters takes into account illuminator temperature, e.g., via a thermistor **114** positioned adjacent the illuminator. The positions adjacent the illuminator include areas providing an accurate representation of illuminator temperature (either actual or correlated). Touch temperature on the temple of **104a** near (e.g., within half of centimeter) of the illuminators has good correlation with the actual temperature of the illuminators. Touch temperature may be an operation parameter set at a maximum value of 55 degrees Celsius, as an example.

(25) Conventional systems address bright ambient light conditions by increasing current to the illuminators to increase brightness without adjusting illuminator on duration times, which has limited effectiveness due to thermal limitation of the illuminators. Additionally, such systems typically require an active control loop including a color sensor to maintain the system white point due to the non-linear brightness response of illuminators such as LEDs to current increases.

(26) By cycling the illuminators, for example, as taught in FIGS. **4A** and **4B**, the system can maintain the illuminator temperature in a safe operating range for a longer operational time.

Additionally, active control loops such as those found in conventional system can be avoided.

(27) FIG. **6** depicts a flow chart of example steps for use in displaying images by an electronic device such as eyewear **100**. Although eyewear device **100** is described in the following example, it is apparent from the description herein that other types of electronic device where illuminators generate light may benefit from implementing the method. Additionally, one of skill in the art will understand suitable modification from the description here such as omission of one or more of the steps and/or performance in a different order.

(28) At step **602**, initiate request to turn on the light projector. In an example, the light projector may include SLM **110** and illumination device **200**. System controller **302** of eyewear device **100** may initiate the request to turn on SLM **110** and illumination device **200**, e.g., in response to an instruction to display information via lens **108a** of eyewear device **100**.

(29) At step **604**, read ambient light sensor. System controller **302** may read an ambient light level by periodically polling ALS **112**. ALS **112** may be positioned on eyewear device **100** to provide an accurate reading of the light level the user is experiencing while wearing the eyewear device **100** (or a value with good correlation to the light level).

(30) At step **606**, obtain illuminator timing and current settings. System controller **302** may read values from a lookup table in memory **304**. The lookup table may include multiple timing entries where each timing entry corresponds to a different ambient light level. In this example, system controller **302** reads the timing values from the lookup table associated with the current ambient

light level read from ALS **112**. For a four color sequence, the timing sequence includes four timing values (t.sub.R, t.sub.G, t.sub.B, and t.sub.W) for each of multiple ambient light level ranges. For a seven color sequence, the timing sequence includes seven timing values (t.sub.R, t.sub.G, t.sub.B, t.sub.C, t.sub.M, t.sub.Y, and t.sub.W) for each of multiple ambient light level ranges. The same or a different lookup table may include initial current settings for the illuminators.

(31) At step **608**, load the timing sequence into an adaptive spatial light modulator. System controller **302** may load the timing sequence from step **606** into SLM **110**, which in turn, controls current controller **312** to selectively switch current on/off to illuminators **306**, **308**, and **310**.

(32) At step **610**, load current settings into current controller. System controller **302** may load the current setting from step **606** into SLM **110**.

(33) At step **612**, turn on the projector. System controller **302** may turn on SLM **110** and current controller **312** after loading timing sequences into SLM **110** and loading current settings into current controller **312**.

(34) At step **614**, read temperature associated with the projector illuminators. System controller **302** may periodically read the temperature from thermistor **114**. The temperature may be an actual temperature of the illuminators from a position in very close proximity or a correlated temperature from a nearby location such as on or near the surface of the temple **104a** containing the illuminators (e.g., touch temperature).

(35) At step **616**, determine if temperature is within an acceptable range. System controller **302** may compare the periodically read temperature values to acceptable temperature limits (e.g., a threshold value selected below an acceptable touch temperature of 55 degrees Celsius, as an example). If the temperature is acceptable, at step **618**, the system waits a predetermined period of time (e.g., 10 seconds) before reading the temperature again. System controller **302** repeats steps **614**, **616**, and **618** for as long as the temperature from thermistor **114** is below the acceptable range.

(36) At step **620**, when the read temperature is not within the acceptable range, current to the illuminators is reduced. System controller **302** may instruct current controller **312** to reduce current by a predetermined amount (e.g., 1% or approximately 1%). Current to the individual illuminators (e.g., i.sub.R, i.sub.G, and i.sub.B) may be reduced proportionally using current derating curves for the individual illuminators in order to maintain the white point of the system.

(37) At step **622**, the system waits a predetermined period of time (e.g., 10 seconds) before reading the temperature again. System controller **302** repeats steps **614**, **616**, **620** and **622** for as long as the temperature from thermistor **114** is at or above the acceptable range.

(38) System controller **302** may additionally adjust timing of illuminators if ambient light levels change while the projector is on. For example, if ambient light levels increase above a predetermined amount (e.g., 5,000 lux), system controller **302** may increase the percentage on time of the overlapping colors (e.g., t.sub.W in a four color system and t.sub.C, t.sub.M, t.sub.Y, and t.sub.W in a seven color system) to improve visibility. Conversely, if ambient light levels decrease below a predetermined amount (e.g., 5,000 lux), system controller **302** may decrease the percentage on time of the overlapping colors (e.g., t.sub.W in a four color system and t.sub.C, t.sub.M, t.sub.Y, and t.sub.W in a seven color system) to reduce power consumption. When the duration of the overlapping color(s) is reduced/increased, the duration of the non-overlapping colors (t.sub.R, t.sub.G, and t.sub.B) may be increased/reduced to compensate for the time in the illumination frame that the overlapping color(s) are no longer in use.

(39) The scope of protection is limited solely by the claims that now follow. That scope is intended and should be interpreted to be as broad as is consistent with the ordinary meaning of the language that is used in the claims when interpreted in light of this specification and the prosecution history that follows and to encompass all structural and functional equivalents. Notwithstanding, none of the claims are intended to embrace subject matter that fails to satisfy the requirement of Sections 101, 102, or 103 of the Patent Act, nor should they be interpreted in such a way. Any unintended embracement of such subject matter is hereby disclaimed.

(40) Except as stated immediately above, nothing that has been stated or illustrated is intended or should be interpreted to cause a dedication of any component, step, feature, object, benefit, advantage, or equivalent to the public, regardless of whether it is or is not recited in the claims.

(41) It will be understood that the terms and expressions used herein have the ordinary meaning as is accorded to such terms and expressions with respect to their corresponding respective areas of inquiry and study except where specific meanings have otherwise been set forth herein. Relational terms such as first and second and the like may be used solely to distinguish one entity or action from another without necessarily requiring or implying any actual such relationship or order between such entities or actions. The terms “comprises,” “comprising,” “includes,” “including,” or any other variation thereof, are intended to cover a non-exclusive inclusion, such that a process, method, article, or apparatus that comprises or includes a list of elements or steps does not include only those elements or steps but may include other elements or steps not expressly listed or inherent to such process, method, article, or apparatus. An element preceded by “a” or “an” does not, without further constraints, preclude the existence of additional identical elements in the process, method, article, or apparatus that comprises the element.

(42) Unless otherwise stated, any and all measurements, values, ratings, positions, magnitudes, sizes, and other specifications that are set forth in this specification, including in the claims that follow, are approximate, not exact. Such amounts are intended to have a reasonable range that is consistent with the functions to which they relate and with what is customary in the art to which they pertain. For example, unless expressly stated otherwise, a parameter value or the like may vary by as much as $\pm 10\%$ from the stated amount.

(43) In addition, in the foregoing Detailed Description, it can be seen that various features are grouped together in various examples for the purpose of streamlining the disclosure. This method of disclosure is not to be interpreted as reflecting an intention that the claimed examples require more features than are expressly recited in each claim. Rather, as the following claims reflect, the subject matter to be protected lies in less than all features of any single disclosed example. Thus, the following claims are hereby incorporated into the Detailed Description, with each claim standing on its own as a separately claimed subject matter.

(44) While the foregoing has described what are considered to be the best mode and other examples, it is understood that various modifications may be made therein and that the subject matter disclosed herein may be implemented in various forms and examples, and that they may be applied in numerous applications, only some of which have been described herein. It is intended by the following claims to claim any and all modifications and variations that fall within the true scope of the present concepts.

Claims

1. An eyewear device comprising: a lens defining a waveguide; a support structure adapted to be worn on a head of a user, the support structure configured to support the lens in a viewing area visible to the user when wearing the support structure; an illumination device including a plurality of illumination sources, each illumination source including a first illuminator adapted to emit light at a first frequency, a second illuminator adapted to emit light at a second frequency, and a third illuminator adapted to emit light at a third frequency, wherein the first, second, and third frequencies are different; projection optics configured to project light from the plurality of illumination sources into the waveguide for routing to the viewing area; a current controller coupled to the illumination device to control current to each of the first, second, and third illuminators; a temperature sensor to sense temperature associated with the illumination device; and a controller coupled to the temperature sensor and the current controller, the current controller individually adjusting current to each of the first, second, and third illuminators responsive to the controller based on the sensed temperature.

2. The eyewear device of claim 1, further comprising: a spatial light modulator coupled to the illumination device to control when each of the first, second, and third illuminators are on during an illumination frame; wherein the first, second, and third illuminators are time sequenced over the illumination frame.
3. The eyewear device of claim 2, wherein the spatial light modulator is adapted to turn on the first illuminator while the second and third illuminators are off during a first time period of the illumination frame, turn on the second illuminator while the first and third illuminators are off during a second time period of the illumination frame, turn on the third illuminator while the first and second illuminators are off during a third time period of the illumination frame, and turn on the first, second and third illuminators during a fourth time period of the illumination frame, wherein the first, second, third, and fourth time periods do not overlap.
4. The eyewear device of claim 1, wherein the controller reduces current to at least one of the first, second, and third illuminators using the current controller responsive to the sensed temperature.
5. The eyewear device of claim 4, wherein the current controller reduces the current to the illuminators in accordance with current derating curves for the individual illuminators to maintain the white point of the illumination sources.
6. The eyewear device of claim 1, wherein the controller adjusts current to each of the first, second, and third illuminators to operate at a first brightness for a first temperature and at a second brightness for a second temperature.
7. The eyewear device of claim 1, wherein the support structure comprises a temple and the temperature sensor is positioned adjacent the temple near the illuminators.
8. The eyewear device of claim 1, wherein the first illuminator is a red light emitting diode (LED), the second illuminator is a green LED, and the third illuminator is a blue LED.
9. An illumination method for an illumination device in an eyewear device, the illumination method comprising: sensing temperature associated with illumination sources of the illumination device, each illumination source including a first illuminator adapted to emit light at a first frequency, a second illuminator adapted to emit light at a second frequency, and a third illuminator adapted to emit light at a third frequency, wherein the first, second, and third frequencies are different; and illuminating, with a controller, the illumination sources by selectively controlling current to the first, second, and third illuminators using a current controller based on the sensed temperature.
10. The illumination method of claim 9, further comprising: controlling when each of the first, second, and third illuminators are on during an illumination frame using a spatial light modulator coupled to the illumination device; wherein the controller reduces current to at least one of the first, second, and third illuminators using the current device responsive to the sensed temperature.
11. The illumination method of claim 10, wherein the illuminating comprises: turning on the first illuminator while the second and third illuminators are off during a first time period of the illumination frame; turning on the second illuminator while the first and third illuminators are off during a second time period of the illumination frame; turning on the third illuminator while the first and second illuminators are off during a third time period of the illumination frame; and turning on the first, second and third illuminators during a fourth time period of the illumination frame; wherein the first, second, third, and fourth time periods do not overlap.
12. The illumination method of claim 9, wherein the illuminating comprises: reducing current to at least one of the first, second, and third illuminators using the current controller responsive to the sensed temperature.
13. The illumination method of claim 12, wherein the illuminating comprises: maintaining the white point of the illumination sources by reducing current to the illuminators in accordance with current derating curves for the individual illuminators.
14. The illumination method of claim 9, wherein the illuminating comprises: adjusting current to each of the first, second, and third illuminators to operate at a first brightness for a first temperature and at a second brightness for a second temperature.

15. A non-transitory computer readable medium including instruction for illuminating illumination sources of a device, the instructions, when executed by a controller, configure the device to: sense temperature associated with the illumination sources of the device, each illumination source including a first illuminator adapted to emit light at a first frequency, a second illuminator adapted to emit light at a second frequency, and a third illuminator adapted to emit light at a third frequency, wherein the first, second, and third frequencies are different; and illuminate the illumination sources by selectively controlling current to the first, second, and third illuminators using a current controller based on the sensed temperature.
16. The non-transitory computer readable medium of claim 15, wherein the instructions, when executed by a controller, further configure the device to: control when each of the first, second, and third illuminators are on during an illumination frame using a spatial light modulator; wherein the controller reduces current to at least one of the first, second, and third illuminators using the current device responsive to the sensed temperature.
17. The non-transitory computer readable medium of claim 16, wherein to illuminate the illumination sources, the instructions, when executed by a controller, further configure the device to: turn on the first illuminator while the second and third illuminators are off during a first time period of the illumination frame; turn on the second illuminator while the first and third illuminators are off during a second time period of the illumination frame; turn on the third illuminator while the first and second illuminators are off during a third time period of the illumination frame; and turn on the first, second and third illuminators during a fourth time period of the illumination frame; wherein the first, second, third, and fourth time periods do not overlap.
18. The non-transitory computer readable medium of claim 15, wherein to illuminate the illumination sources, the instructions, when executed by a controller, further configure the device to: reduce current to at least one of the first, second, and third illuminators using the current controller responsive to the sensed temperature.
19. The non-transitory computer readable medium of claim 18, wherein to illuminate the illumination sources, the instructions, when executed by a controller, further configure the device to: maintain the white point of the illumination sources by reducing current to the illuminators in accordance with current derating curves for the individual illuminators.
20. The non-transitory computer readable medium of claim 15, wherein to illuminate the illumination sources, the instructions, when executed by a controller, further configure the device to: adjust current to each of the first, second, and third illuminators to operate at a first brightness for a first temperature and at a second brightness for a second temperature.
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